this is the app that i want to run:

https://github.com/jellyfin/jellyfin-mpv-shim

You can keep Raspberry Pi OS Lite and run jellyfin-mpv-shim as the only full-screen GUI by combining a minimal X setup with shim's own fullscreen/desktop options.[1] [2]

Below assumes Raspberry Pi OS Lite on a Pi 4, HDMI to TV, and that you control playback from another Jellyfin client (phone/PC).

1. Install minimal GUI + mpv + shim

SSH into the Pi and run:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install --no-install-recommends \
    xserver-xorg xinit x11-xserver-utils openbox \
    mpv python3-pip python3-tk
```

Install jellyfin-mpv-shim via pip:

```
sudo pip3 install --upgrade jellyfin-mpv-shim
```

This gives you the GUI desktop window for browsing plus the MPV player backend.[3] [4]

2. Configure shim for fullscreen "dashboard"

Start shim once over SSH to create config:

```
jellyfin-mpv-shim
```

Close it, then edit its config (path is typically):

```
nano ~/.config/jellyfin-mpv-shim/jellyfin-mpv-shim.conf
```

Set these options (add them if missing):

```
desktop_fullscreen = true
```

```
fullscreen = true
```

- `desktop_fullscreen` makes the shim's own window occupy the full screen like a dashboard.[1]
- `fullscreen` ensures MPV goes fullscreen when playing.[5] [4]

You can also set your Jellyfin server URL and default client there, or just log in once via the shim GUI and let it save settings.[3]

3. Minimal X session that only runs shim

Create `~/.xinitrc` for your user (e.g. `pi`):

```
nano ~/.xinitrc
```

Put:

```
#!/bin/sh
# prevent screen blanking
xset s off
xset -dpms
xset s noblank

# tiny window manager, no panels
openbox &

# run jellyfin-mpv-shim GUI
exec jellyfin-mpv-shim
```

Make it executable:

```
chmod +x ~/.xinitrc
```

Test manually (with the TV plugged in):

```
startx
```

You should see the jellyfin-mpv-shim window full screen; casting from another Jellyfin client should pop MPV up fullscreen as well.[2] [1]

4. Auto-start on boot (kiosk-style)

Create a systemd unit:

```
sudo nano /etc/systemd/system/jellyfin-shim-kiosk.service
```

Contents (adjust `User=` if not `pi`):

```
[Unit]
Description=Jellyfin MPV Shim Kiosk
After=systemd-user-sessions.service getty@tty1.service
Wants=getty@tty1.service

[Service]
User=pi
Environment=DISPLAY=:0
Environment=XAUTHORITY=/home/pi/.Xauthority
TTYPath=/dev/tty1
PAMName=login
Type=simple
ExecStart=/bin/bash -lc 'xinit -- /usr/bin/X :0 vt1 -nocursor'
Restart=always

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Enable it:

```
sudo systemctl daemon-reload
sudo systemctl enable jellyfin-shim-kiosk.service
# optional: hide login prompt on tty1
sudo systemctl disable getty@tty1.service
sudo reboot
```

After reboot, the Pi should boot straight into X and show only jellyfin-mpv-shim on your TV.[2]

5. HDMI tweaks if needed

If the TV sometimes doesn't wake, force HDMI:

```
sudo nano /boot/config.txt
```

Add:

```
hdmi_force_hotplug=1
hdmi_group=1
hdmi_mode=16   # 1080p60; change if you want another mode
```

Then reboot.

If you tell me whether you want to use it only as a cast target (no local navigation) or also browse Jellyfin from the TV, I can tweak the config for that use case.

⁂

1. https://www.reddit.com/r/jellyfin/comments/ie2d8q/mpv_shim_full_screen_mode/
2. https://github.com/iwalton3/jellyfin-mpv-shim/issues/57
3. https://pypi.org/project/jellyfin-mpv-shim/1.3.8/
4. https://pypi.org/project/jellyfin-mpv-shim/
5. https://github.com/jellyfin/jellyfin-mpv-shim/discussions/339
6. https://www.reddit.com/r/jellyfin/comments/oqj94c/portable_jellyfin_client_not_server_on_raspberry/
7. https://github.com/jellyfin/jellyfin-media-player/issues/71
8. https://www.reddit.com/r/selfhosted/comments/1ksxqgc/jellyfin_with_mpvlibplacebo_on_standalone_box/
9. https://winstall.app/apps/IanWalton.JellyfinMPVShim
10. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jolwxgNjCoc